GLOBAL MARKETING STRATEGY · CASE STUDY

A French luxury house enters Japan — which consumer to win, and how

A market-entry strategy for a Parisian luxury brand expanding into Japan: using cultural analysis and cross-cultural segmentation to choose the right consumer, the right positioning, and the right product to launch with.

University of Leeds · MSc Marketing

Cross-Cultural Consumer Strategy

Hofstede · GCCP · Conjoint of culture

6	3	Segment B	GCCP
Cultural dimensions analysed	Consumer segments profiled	The clear target	Positioning strategy

BRIEF

The problem

A French luxury brand — Parisian heritage, fine craftsmanship, exclusivity — wanted to expand into Japan but faced three decisions: *which* Japanese consumer to target, *how* to position a foreign luxury brand in a culture that prizes tradition, and *what* product to lead with.

A premium brand entering Japan risks rejection if it reads as culturally tone-deaf. My job was to ground the entry strategy in cultural evidence rather than assumption.

APPROACH

Culture-first strategy

I built the strategy in three layers: a **Hofstede analysis** of Japan's cultural profile, a **segmentation** of Japanese consumers by their disposition toward foreign brands, and a **positioning + product** recommendation tied to consumer-culture-positioning theory and cognitive framing.

Hofstede cultural dimensions | Consumer-disposition segmentation | GCCP / LCCP / FCCP frameworks | Analytical vs holistic framing | Go-to-market product design

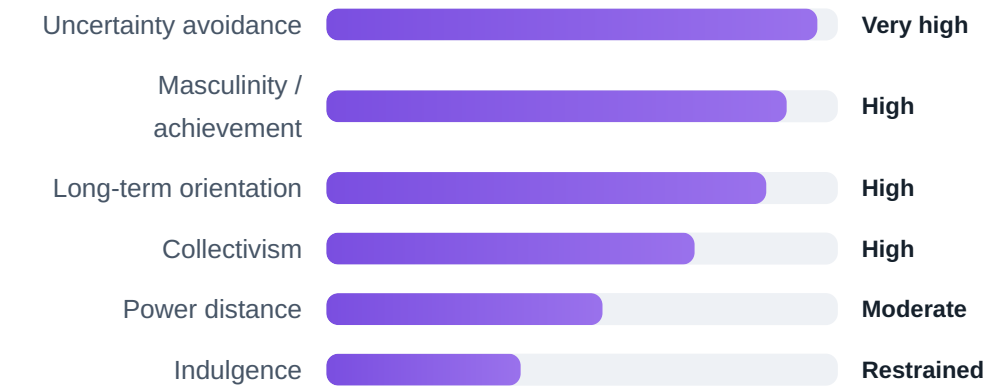
RESULT 1

The cultural fit

Japan's cultural profile maps almost perfectly onto a heritage luxury brand — especially its very high uncertainty avoidance (a demand for authenticity and provenance) and long-term orientation (valuing heirloom-quality goods).

Japan's cultural profile, as characterised in the analysis

Relative strength of each Hofstede dimension and what it means for a luxury entrant.

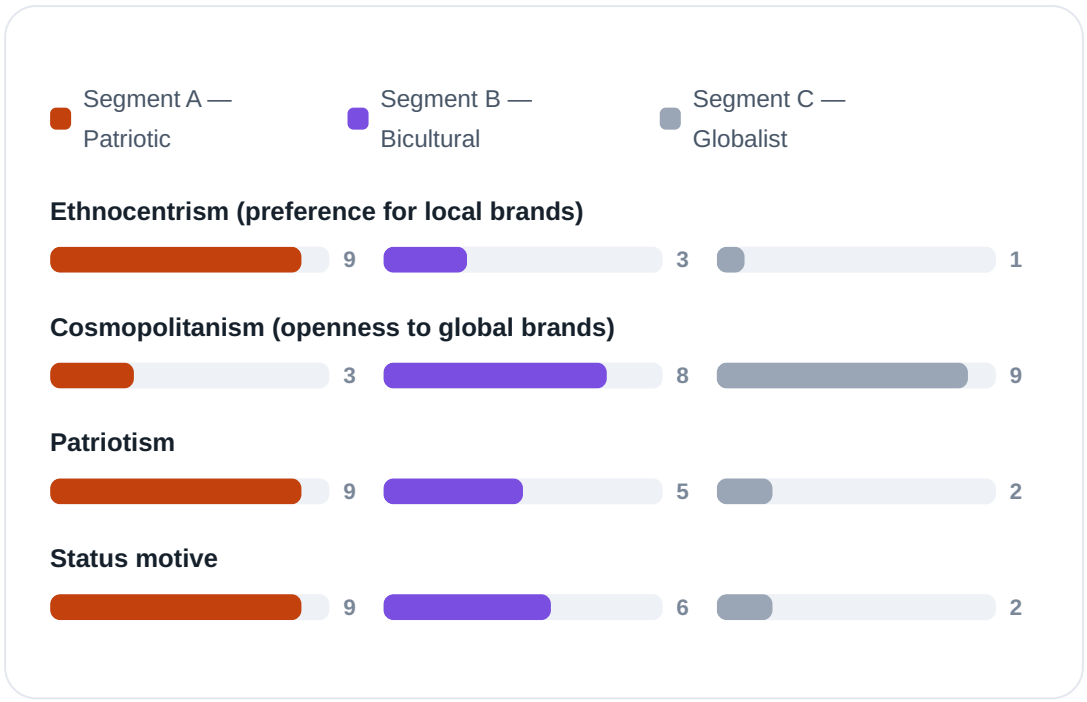


The takeaway: Japanese luxury buyers prefer **discreet, heritage-led prestige** over flashy display — and demand proof of authenticity. The brand's craftsmanship story is its biggest asset here.

RESULT 2

Who to target — 3 segments

I profiled three Japanese consumer segments on their disposition toward foreign brands (ethnocentrism, cosmopolitanism, patriotism, status motive — each scored 1–10). The contrast made the target obvious.



× Avoid

Segment A — Patriotic

Strongly ethnocentric, loyal to local brands, low openness. High rejection risk for a foreign house. Not worth the spend.

✓ Target

Segment B — Bicultural

Balanced: open to global luxury yet respects local culture, with the highest uniqueness & variety-seeking (9/10). The sweet spot.

~ Short-term only

Segment C — Globalist

Very open to foreign brands but low on status, loyalty and heritage — unlikely to sustain a premium relationship.

RESULT 3

How to position

For Segment B's bicultural mindset, I recommended a **Global Consumer Culture Positioning (GCCP)** strategy — presenting the brand as a symbol of worldwide prestige while signalling genuine respect for Japanese culture — paired with **holistic cognitive framing** that leads with symbolism, emotion and story rather than spec-by-spec reasoning.

□

Why it works: Segment B buys foreign luxury for global prestige *but* retains local pride — GCCP lets the brand be aspirational and culturally respectful at once, the only framing that satisfies both pulls.

SO WHAT

The go-to-market move

I translated the strategy into a concrete launch: a **"Kyoto Artisan × Maison" limited collection** — heritage handbags co-created with a traditional Japanese artisan, drawing on Kyoto motifs and kimono fabric, sold through an immersive, craft-demonstrating retail experience.

1. **Target Segment B** — the bicultural consumer who wants both global prestige and cultural respect.
2. **Position with GCCP + holistic framing** — lead with heritage, craftsmanship and provenance storytelling, not feature lists.
3. **Launch the Kyoto Artisan collaboration** — local co-creation delivers the uniqueness this segment craves while honouring Japanese identity.
4. **Lead with authenticity proof** — certificates, craftsmanship demos and after-sales service to satisfy Japan's high uncertainty avoidance.

Aadarsh Dhananjay Tripathi

MSc International Marketing Management with Marketing Analysis · University of Leeds

Frameworks: Hofstede · Alden et al. (GCCP) · Full report available on request